

Helix VPN Constitution

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This constitution **extends** the Helix Universal Constitution at constitution/Constitution.md. All clauses there apply unless explicitly overridden below with an explicit Override §X.Y section.

Overrides

None.

Updating the constitution submodule (§11.4.26)

When a new version of the Helix Universal Constitution is published, follow this 7-step pipeline exactly. Never skip or reorder steps.

Step 1 — Fetch and pull all remotes inside the submodule

```
cd constitution
git fetch --all
git pull --ff-only origin main    # fast-forward only; never force
                                   inside the submodule
cd ..
```

Step 2 — Apply the change

Review the diff before proceeding:

```
git diff constitution/Constitution.md | head -80
```

If the update is as expected, move on. If you see unexpected changes, abort and investigate the upstream.

Step 3 — Validate via post-update script

Run the post-update hook and full rule verification in one command:

```
bash scripts/post_constitution_update.sh
```

scripts/post_constitution_update.sh invokes the post-update hook and then calls scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh. Both must exit 0 before continuing.

Step 4 — Commit and push to ALL upstreams

Use scripts/commit_all.sh to satisfy the §2.1 multi-upstream push requirement. Do **not** use plain git push; it pushes to only one remote.

```
bash scripts/commit_all.sh  
    "chore(constitution): bump submodule to <short-SHA>"
```

Step 5 — Conflict resolution (if step 4 fails)

If a push is rejected due to a diverged remote:

1. **Never force-push** — this is prohibited by §11.4.26.
2. Fetch the conflicting remote: git fetch <remote>
3. Rebase locally: git rebase <remote>/<branch>
4. Re-run scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh to confirm validity after rebase.
5. Retry scripts/commit_all.sh.

Step 6 — Post-merge validation via cascade verifier

After the push succeeds, run the full test suite to confirm nothing broke:

```
bash test_all.sh  
# expected final line: OVERALL STATUS: PASS
```

Step 7 — Bump the submodule pointer in the consuming project

The bumped pointer must be committed in the **same** commit as any consuming-project changes that depend on the new constitution content. scripts/commit_all.sh in step 4 handles this when called from the repo root after cd constitution && git pull.

Verify the pointer is updated:

```
git submodule status  
# Should show the new SHA without a leading '+'
```

Project-specific clauses

None yet — Helix VPN is in early scaffolding (Go). Project-specific clauses (service names, ports, protocol versions, numeric thresholds, dependency workarounds) live here, never in the constitution submodule.